

Student Projects budgets: process

i) Executive summary

The James Watt School of Engineering is committed to teaching innovation and providing a world class student experience. To support this, several General Funds budgets are in place to ensure that learning and teaching activities are properly resourced. The Student Projects budget exists to support MSc, MEng (including Design Special Topics) and BEng final year projects, excluding students on industrial placement. As this is a general funds sub-project, any unspent funds at the end of the financial year cannot be carried forward.

This document outlines the responsibilities of project supervisors and the School resource team to ensure that available funds are used appropriately. While the overall level of funding available remains consistent with previous years, the timelines for spending and the role of the School resource team have been updated to support responsible financial stewardship. A maximum allocation is provided per project to guide planning; however, not all projects may require the full amount.

Implementation of this process is effective from financial year 2026 which commenced 1st August 2025.

ii) Allocation

The Student Projects allocation is calculated at a rate of £200 per student. An additional £3,000 incentive is available to supervisors with projects attracting 20+ students.

The £200 per student should be used to benefit the student; this could be spent per head or pooled to purchase something for project-related activity. The £3,000 incentive can be spent at the discretion of the supervisor and can be spent up to mid-May in year 2 (i.e. the following financial year from when it was awarded).

Sub-project	Sub-project (T)	Budget holder
123599-01	MSc Student Projects	DoLT/AHoS
247450-01	BEng Student Projects	DoLT/AHoS
Do247451-01	MEng Student Projects	DoLT/AHoS

iii) Timelines (project start and end dates and associated spending windows are reviewed each year, and updated annually where required)

Programme	Student projects allocated	Project start-end dates	Spend window
MSc	Early-April	Mid-May - August	1 April - 15 June
MEng	January	June - November	1 January - 30 June
BEng	September	Mid October -April	1 September - 7 March
Design Special Topic 5 (MEng)	Mid-January	January-May	1 January - 7 April

Supervisor incentive	As above	As above	Projects may spend across two financial years, with a 15 May deadline in the following year, in line with the confirmed spend profile
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Responsibilities of project supervisors

- Once projects and numbers of students have been finalised, supervisors should outline their equipment requirements placing orders as soon as possible.
- Supervisors are responsible for monitoring their own spend. Spot checks will be carried out by the School finance team.
- Supervisors are responsible for spending within the allotted timeframe; unspent funds will be reallocated after the deadline:
 - Funds cannot be carried forward across financial year.
 - Supervisor Incentive funds are available until the May of the following financial year but spend profile must be confirmed upfront with the School finance team.
- In the case of Design Special Topic 5 only, the course coordinator will provide finalised student numbers to the School finance team as per dates outlined above.
- All orders should quote the relevant sub-project code (outlined above).
- All orders should include supervisor and student names in the text reference field.
- As with all projects, spend is governed by the University's [procurement policy](#).
- When ordering consumables from Stores Services, please follow the [instructions outlined on their webpage](#).
- Any other orders should be placed using the usual processes; some useful contacts are included below. For queries, contact School finance team eng-finance@glasgow.ac.uk

Responsibilities of School finance and resource team

- Once projects and student numbers are confirmed, the finance and resource team will email individual supervisors confirming budget allocations and deadlines for spend.
- The team will confirm incentive allocations with applicable supervisors, requesting the expected spend profile so that the budget can be adjusted accordingly.
- The team will monitor spend on the sub-projects and provide financial updates to the Project Leads. This will be issued on the last working day of the month during the project cycle and indicate balance remaining to individual supervisors. Information is available directly to supervisors on request.
- The team will issue a final reminder about impending financial deadlines.
- Any unspent funds after the deadlines will be reallocated to School strategic projects.
- The team will perform regular spot checks to ensure budget allocations are adhered to.
- The team can provide general advice on accessing and purchasing from funds, or any other management information on request. The team is located in James Watt South, room 650, or can be contacted as listed below.

Responsibilities of MSc/MEng/BEng project administration

- The project administration team will provide student numbers to the School finance and resource team once they are finalised (usually November). This is to allow sub-project budgets to be finalised.
- The team will provide a finalised list of student names and their supervisors to the School finance and resource team by the dates noted above. This is to allow individual supervisor budgets and incentives to be communicated to relevant parties and financial activity to be tracked.

Responsibilities of purchasers

- Student orders can be placed using the instructions outlined on the [Stores Services webpage](#) using the [Stores order form](#).
- Orders with contracted suppliers will be made by the Stores team. Stores will refer orders with non-contracted suppliers, or orders being placed by purchasing card, to the CoSE Transactions Hub to be processed.
- Purchasers will include supervisor names on all orders to allow spending to be tracked through Agresso.

Key contacts

Team/Individual	Contact details
BEng Projects coordinator	Bernd Porr: Bernd.Porr@glasgow.ac.uk (successor TBC)
MEng Projects coordinator	Dave Moran: David.Moran@glasgow.ac.uk
MSc Projects coordinator	TBC
Design Special Topic 5 (MEng) Coordinator	Konstanze Hild: Konstanze.Hild@glasgow.ac.uk
MSc Projects administration	eng-pgt-admin@glasgow.ac.uk
BEng/MEng Projects administration	Ola Olaniyan: Olatokunbo.Olaniyan@glasgow.ac.uk
School Finance & Resource team	eng-finance@glasgow.ac.uk
Stores	eng-stores@glasgow.ac.uk
Transaction Hub (POs, requisitions, conference bookings, etc)	cose-fintranshub1@glasgow.ac.uk
IT	Please submit requests via the helpdesk
Travel	Please submit bookings via the Travel Hub